

Speaking

Athlete Interview Role-Play

Pairs · 8-10 min

One student plays a journalist and the other plays an athlete or coach after an important match. The journalist asks at least five questions; the athlete/coach answers in character. Afterwards, each pair reports three things their partner said to the class using reported speech.

Useful language: Can you tell us how you feel about...?, What was the turning point of the match?, I felt that..., Our coach told us that..., He/She said (that)..., He/She told me (that)...

1. In pairs, decide who is the journalist and who is the athlete/coach.
2. The journalist prepares 5 interview questions about a recent match or competition.
3. Role-play the interview, speaking naturally.
4. Swap roles and repeat with a new topic.
5. Each student reports 3 things their partner said to the class, using reported speech.

Sports Debate: Fair Play vs Winning at All Costs

Groups of 3-4 · 10-12 min

In small groups, students discuss whether winning is more important than playing fairly, using examples from sports they know. Each group presents a short summary of their discussion to the class, including at least one reported statement from a group member.

Useful language: In my opinion..., I think fair play is more important because..., Some people believe that..., One of my classmates said that..., I disagree because...

1. In groups, discuss: Is it acceptable to break the rules if it helps your team win?
2. Give real or imagined examples of fair play and unfair play in sports.
3. Agree on a short group opinion.
4. Choose one group member to summarise the discussion for the class, quoting a group member's opinion in reported speech.

Writing

Write a Sports News Report

120-150 words

Write a short sports news report about an imaginary match or competition. Include a headline, the result, at least two reported statements from a player or coach, and a closing sentence about what happens next.

Plan:

1. Choose a sport and decide the result of the match/competition.
2. Write a short, catchy headline.
3. Note down 2-3 quotes a player or coach might have said.
4. Turn those quotes into reported speech for your report.
5. Add a final sentence about future plans (next match, tournament, etc.).

Checklist:

- ☐ Does my report have a clear headline?
- ☐ Have I included the score/result?
- ☐ Have I used at least two correctly formed reported statements?
- ☐ Have I checked tense back-shift and pronoun changes?

Interview Script and Summary

150-180 words

Write a short interview script (5 questions and answers) with an imaginary athlete or coach about a recent competition. Then write a short paragraph (4-6 sentences) summarising the interview using reported speech.

Plan:

1. Choose your interviewee (athlete, coach) and the topic (a recent win, a big goal, an injury, etc.).
2. Write 5 interview questions.
3. Write natural, original answers for the interviewee.
4. Rewrite the key answers as reported speech in a short summary paragraph.
5. Check that reporting verbs (said, told, explained, admitted) are used correctly.

Checklist:

- ☐ Does my script have 5 clear questions and answers?
- ☐ Does my summary paragraph use reported speech correctly?
- ☐ Have I used at least two different reporting verbs?
- ☐ Is my paragraph well organised with linking words?